

	direction. He remained under the table for 5–7 minutes on each day. He joined the group after a teacher sat beside him and offered a specific task.
Why this is better: The objective version describes specific, observable actions including time, frequency, and exact words. It does not label the child or interpret the behavior. Anyone reading this record can understand exactly what occurred.	

Example 7: Peer Interaction

✗ Instead of writing:	✓ Write instead:
<i>She has no friends and doesn't know how to play with other kids.</i>	Over the past three weeks, Sofia played independently or beside peers on 14 out of 15 observed days. On 1 day, she entered a peer's play and stayed for 4 minutes before leaving. She has not yet initiated conversation with peers during observation periods.
Why this is better: The objective version describes specific, observable actions including time, frequency, and exact words. It does not label the child or interpret the behavior. Anyone reading this record can understand exactly what occurred.	